

# UX spatial journey mapping

**What this tool produces** · *A chronological matrix highlighting the specific "pain points" and emotional responses of an individual moving through an urban environment, identifying precise locations for improvement.*

**G1 · Proof of Impact**

**Dimensions**

**Social / User**

**Spatial**

# Preparing the workshop · *UX spatial journey mapping*

## G1 · Proof of Impact

### Why this tool matters

Validating the individual's struggle against the city; proving that a minor curb or a dark alleyway is not a mere technical detail, but a profound barrier to human freedom.

### Evidence we produce

A chronological matrix highlighting the specific "pain points" and emotional responses of an individual moving through an urban environment, identifying precise locations for improvement.

### Duration & Material

Duration · 1 day of field tracking and 1 day of workshop synthesis

Material · Empathy maps, user journey matrices, cameras, field recording notebooks

### Reference case

During the URBACT "Re-Gen" network meeting in Dobrich, cities employed Empathy Maps and User journey mapping within a Service Design workshop. Participants tracked the experiences of young people navigating urban sports spaces. By systematically identifying pain points and barriers to participation, planners transitioned from isolated events to designing genuinely inclusive, long-lasting sports hubs.

**Suggested agenda** · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Spatial journey · place × moment × experience

Duration  
1 day of field tracking and 1 day of workshop synthesis

| Place        | Place 1 | Place 2 | Place 3 | Place 4 | Place 5 | Place 6 |
|--------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| User actions |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Emotion      |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Sensory cues |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Friction     |         |         |         |         |         |         |
| Spatial cue  |         |         |         |         |         |         |

# Harvesting our *learnings*

*After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.*

**What inspires me**

*Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember*

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**How to apply it here**

*Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints*

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**What we need to be autonomous**

*Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure*

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*Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.*